

CITATIONS & WEB 2.0 · CAPABILITY & ECONOMICS

Citations & Web 2.0 Backlinks

What we automate, the sites we use, and the real cost.

A straight answer to three questions — can citation building and Web 2.0 backlinks be automated (yes, Playwright included), which sites we submit to across the US, UK, Canada & Australia, and proof every unit lands **under your 10¢ ceiling**. No hand-waving: where automation is safe and cheap, we say so; where it isn't, we say that too.

Under 10¢

Per citation & per backlink — with margin to spare

4 markets

US · UK · Canada · Australia, general local business

~180 dirs

Citation directories mapped & categorised

25+ APIs

Web 2.0 platforms with live publishing APIs

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PREPARED BY

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DATE

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SCOPE

General local
business

01 THE HONEST PICTURE

What can — and can't — be automated

Most of the work automates cleanly — a slice just needs a light assist to clear a CAPTCHA or a verification step. We build to that line, never around it.

Fully automated

Runs end-to-end over an official API or our own bot — no human in the loop.

Assisted

Our bot fills it, a low-cost CAPTCHA-solver clears the gate, a human approves the send.

Local citations

- **Automated** — push once to **Data Axle · Foursquare · Neustar**; they seed hundreds of directories downstream.
- **Automated** — **Bing Places & Foursquare** accept listings straight over their API.
- **Automated** — ~30 long-tail directories per market are plain forms **our bot fills** (Hotfrog, Brownbook, Cylex...).
- **Assisted** — ~15–19 per market (Yelp, YellowPages, Manta) need a CAPTCHA solver + a human OK.
- **Assisted** — a handful use phone or email verification — cleared once, then the listing stays live.

Web 2.0 backlinks

- **Automated** — 8 clean official APIs: **WordPress.com, Blogger, Tumblr, Ghost, Write.as, Telegra.ph, dev.to, LiveJournal**.
- **Automated** — ~25–31 platforms in total expose live publishing APIs (Hive, Mastodon, GitHub Pages, Fandom...).
- **Excluded** — **Medium** (API dead since 2023) and site-builders **Weebly / Squarespace / Strikingly** (no API).
- **Discipline** — unique content, human pacing, a **different platform set per client** — never a templated blast.

YOUR PLAYWRIGHT / SELENIUM QUESTION

Yes — and here's exactly where. We run our own Playwright bot to submit the no-CAPTCHA long-tail directories (and the CAPTCHA-gated ones with a low-cost solver plus a human review), and to read and re-verify listings — the same proven engine already in your audit stack. For Web 2.0 we use the official publishing APIs instead: cheaper, faster, and they don't trip bot-detection.

02 COVERAGE

The sites we'll use, market by market

Every market has one canonical directory set. We seed the aggregators once, hit the direct APIs, and let our bot work the long tail — so a single clean NAP record propagates everywhere it should.

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US GENERAL
DIRECTORIES

38

UK GENERAL
DIRECTORIES

40

CANADA GENERAL
DIRECTORIES

40

AUSTRALIA GENERAL
DIRECTORIES

MARKET	PUSH-ONCE AGGREGATORS	DIRECT API	REPRESENTATIVE DIRECTORIES WE SUBMIT TO
United States	Data Axle · Foursquare · Neustar	Bing Places · Foursquare	Yelp, YellowPages, Manta, Hotfrog, Brownbook, Cylex, MerchantCircle, Chamber of Commerce, Superpages
United Kingdom	Foursquare (+ global)	Bing Places	Yell, Thomson Local, FreeIndex, Scoot, Cylex UK, Hotfrog UK, 192.com, Yelp UK
Canada	Foursquare · Data Axle · Neustar	Bing Places · Foursquare	YellowPages.ca, Canada411, 411.ca, n49, Hotfrog CA, Cylex CA, Ourbis, Weblocal
Australia	Foursquare (+ global)	Bing Places	True Local, Yellow Pages AU, StartLocal, Hotfrog AU, Local Search, Aussie Web, Yelp AU

WEB 2.0 PUBLISHING PLATFORMS — LIVE OFFICIAL APIS

WordPress.com

Blogger

Tumblr

Ghost

Write.as

Telegra.ph

dev.to

LiveJournal

Hive

Mastodon

GitHub Pages

Hatena

FC2

Fandom

Wikidot

Minds

Micro.blog

Mataroa

Populr

Plurk

The **8 green** platforms are our clean, ungated first build; ~25–31 have live APIs in total. **Excluded:** Medium (API dead), and Weebly / Squarespace / Strikingly (no publishing API — not worth the friction).

03 THE ECONOMICS

Every unit, under 10¢

We priced every route to build one citation and one backlink. The methods we use come in at roughly a penny; the convenient shortcuts we avoid are the ones that break your ceiling.

HOW THE UNIT IS PRODUCED	COST PER UNIT	VS 10¢ CEILING
Web 2.0 backlink — official API (WordPress.com / Blogger)	0.02 – 3¢	✓ Under
Citation — our Playwright bot (marginal cost)	0.4 – 0.8¢	✓ Under
Citation — official-API write (Bing / Foursquare)	0.5 – 1.9¢	✓ Under
Citation — our bot, fully loaded (build cost amortised)	~5¢	✓ Under
Citation — Apify off-the-shelf tool (per submit)	25¢	✗ Over 2.5×
Citation — managed service (BrightLocal / Whitespark)	\$2 – \$5	✗ Over 20–50×

HOW WE HOLD THE LINE UNDER 10¢

We **self-host the automation** — our own bot, our own CAPTCHA key, budget proxies — and lean on **official APIs** wherever they exist. That's about **1¢ per citation** and near-free for Web 2.0. The shortcuts we deliberately avoid are the ones that blow the ceiling: the Apify tool at **25¢** a citation and managed services at **\$2–5** — more cost, no more quality.

The one rule that keeps this safe

Google's **March 2026 "Site Reputation Abuse"** update issues **manual** penalties for scaled, templated Web 2.0 networks. We stay clear of it by keeping every property distinct — unique content, human-paced posting, a different platform mix per client. It's a deliberate quality choice, and it's non-negotiable.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU TO START

- Business essentials** — logo, hours, categories and a short description, so every listing is complete and consistent.
- One canonical NAP record** — name, address, phone, hours — as the single source of truth we propagate everywhere.
- Per-client platform accounts** under the client's own identity — never shared across clients (keeps them safe from bans).

BOTTOM LINE

Automated where it's safe and cheap — honest where it isn't. Every unit under your 10¢ ceiling. Xegents